SEO Audit Report

upwise.com.au

38

out of 100

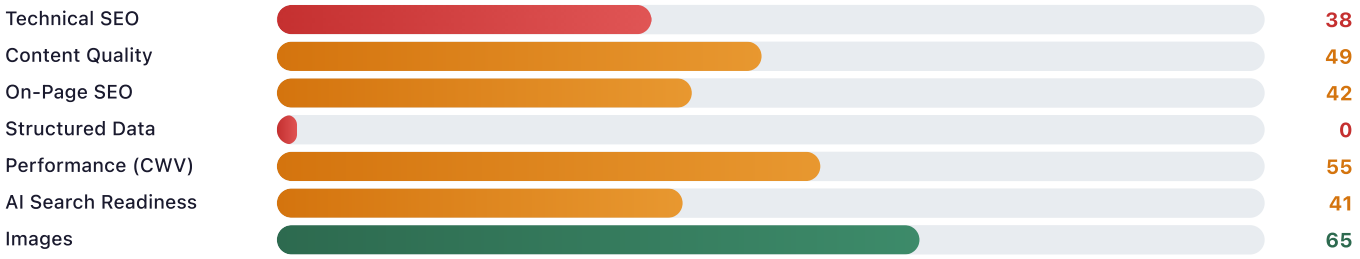
Strong content held back by technical infrastructure.
A focused week of fixes could lift this to 60-65.

Date: 23 April 2026
Business Type: SaaS Educational Platform (Pre-launch)
Platform: Next.js 15 on Railway + Fastly CDN
8 specialist analyses performed in parallel

Executive Summary

Key Insight: The gap between content quality and SEO score is almost entirely a **technical infrastructure problem**, not an editorial one. The hard part — writing genuine, research-backed content — is already done well. Fixing the top 4 technical issues would lift the score from 38 to approximately 60-65.

Overall Health Score: 38 / 100



What's Working Well

- ✓ Research citations are specific, peer-reviewed, and correctly attributed (Nature, PNAS, Harvard)
- ✓ Clear value proposition: "smarter alternative to traditional tutoring" with transparent pricing ($39-$59/mo)
- ✓ Privacy and Terms documents are substantive and reference Australian Privacy Act correctly
- ✓ FAQ content is outstanding — 2,300+ words of parent-friendly, evidence-based answers
- ✓ No AI-generated content red flags — consistent, specific, founder-authored voice
- ✓ Server response time excellent at 0.24 seconds — CDN infrastructure performing well

What's Holding the Score Back

Google can't read the content. The site is built so text only appears after JavaScript runs. When Google visits, it sees an almost-empty page. The FAQ — 2,300 words of great content — shows up as ~200 words to Google.

No roadmap for search engines. robots.txt and sitemap.xml both return 404 errors in production despite existing in the code.

No structured data. Zero schema markup. Every competitor in top 10 results has it.

No security headers. Missing HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options. Critical for a children's education platform.

Detailed Findings

Technical SEO — 38/100

SEVERITY	ISSUE	DETAIL
CRITICAL	robots.txt returns 404	File exists in code but middleware prevents serving in production
CRITICAL	sitemap.xml returns 404	Same static file serving issue — Google has no page discovery
CRITICAL	No canonical tags	Both trailing-slash and non-trailing-slash URLs serve identical content
CRITICAL	No security headers	Missing HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options
HIGH	No Open Graph tags	Social shares on Facebook/LinkedIn produce blank previews
HIGH	Middleware masks 404s	Unknown paths redirect to homepage instead of proper errors
MEDIUM	Dead footer links	About, Blog, Data Protection link to # (nowhere)

Content Quality — 49/100

SEVERITY	ISSUE	DETAIL
CRITICAL	FAQ invisible to Google	2,300 words of research-backed content rendered only via JavaScript
CRITICAL	Homepage behind JS	"use client" directive forces entire page through browser rendering
HIGH	No team/founder info	Zero professional credentials shown — critical E-E-A-T gap
HIGH	Draft banners on legal pages	"Not yet reviewed by a solicitor" displayed on live Privacy & Terms
HIGH	Unsourced "2.6x" claim	Only unsourced statistic on the entire site

MEDIUM	Readability too academic	Flesch score 37.6 (Difficult) — parents need 55-65

Structured Data — 0/100

SEVERITY	ISSUE	DETAIL
CRITICAL	Zero schema markup	No JSON-LD on any page. Missing Organisation, SoftwareApplication, FAQ, WebSite
HIGH	FAQ ideal for schema	Well-structured Q&A pairs ready for markup — benefits AI/LLM citation
HIGH	No product schema	Pricing tiers not structured for Google rich results

AI Search Readiness — 41/100

SEVERITY	ISSUE	DETAIL
CRITICAL	Content invisible to AI	ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI can't extract research citations
HIGH	No llms.txt file	No machine-readable brand description for AI tool ingestion
HIGH	No off-site signals	No YouTube, Reddit, press, or Wikipedia presence

Performance — 55/100

SEVERITY	ISSUE	DETAIL
CRITICAL	LCP risk	Hero heading animated from invisible — delays largest content paint
HIGH	INP risk	Buttons unresponsive until full JavaScript hydration completes
LOW	TTFB excellent (0.24s)	Server response well within "Good" threshold

Competitor Landscape

For target keywords like "online maths tutoring Australia" and "primary school learning app":

COMPETITOR	KEY STRENGTHS	SOCIAL PROOF
Cluey Learning	Active product, video demos, structured data, trial CTA	33,000+ students
Kinetic Education	Service page, star ratings in Google, price anchoring	1,719 verified reviews
MathsOnline	Product homepage, founder visible, video demos	"Australia's #1"
Mathletics	Curriculum badges, gamification, school adoption	Global brand, millions
IXL	Deep curriculum coverage, product homepage	18M+ users worldwide

> **Upwise's advantage:** Research-backed positioning with peer-reviewed citations (Nature, PNAS, Harvard). No competitor in the top 10 cites real research. This is a genuine differentiator — once Google can see it.

Search Experience (SXO) — 38/100

Critical: Page-Type Mismatch

A waitlist page cannot compete against active service pages. Google rewards pages that serve intent *now*.

PAGE TYPE IN SERPS	SHARE OF TOP 10
Active service/conversion pages	**60%**
Comparison/guide articles	25%
Marketplace/review aggregators	10%
Government/institutional	5%
Waitlist / pre-launch pages	**0%**

How Different Parents Experience the Site

PARENT PERSONA	SCORE	KEY GAP
Research-Led Parent	42	Research citations exist but no linked sources, no author credentials
Comparison Shopper	48	No comparison pages — can't find Upwise through natural search
Budget-Conscious Parent	52	$39/mo competitive but "Join Waitlist" kills conversion
Concerned Parent	58	"Why gaps compound" content strong but buried, no testimonials
School-Aware Parent	61	"Teacher-shareable reports" unique but unexplained
Digitally Engaged Parent	67	Value proposition clear, tolerant of pre-launch — no social proof

Priority Action Plan

Must Do Before Launch

#	ACTION	IMPACT	EFFORT
1	**Make content visible to Google** Convert homepage + FAQ to server-side rendering	Unlocks all content for search engines and AI	2-4 days
2	**Fix robots.txt & sitemap.xml** Convert to Next.js route handlers	Enables search engine page discovery	2-3 hours
3	**Add security headers** HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options via next.config.ts	Security compliance + trust signals	2-3 hours
4	**Add structured data (JSON-LD)** Organisation, SoftwareApplication, FAQ, WebSite	Rich results, entity recognition, AI citation	1-2 days
5	**Add canonical + OG tags** Prevent duplicates, enable social previews	Social shares show real previews	2-3 hours
6	**Remove "Draft" banners** From Privacy Policy and Terms of Service	Immediate trust improvement	5 minutes

Do Within 2 Weeks of Launch

#	ACTION	IMPACT	EFFORT
7	**Add founder/team section**	E-E-A-T Expertise + Trustworthiness	1-2 hours
8	**Source the "2.6x faster" claim**	Content credibility	15 minutes
9	**Fix dead footer links**	Trust + crawl quality	30 minutes
10	**Create llms.txt**	ChatGPT + Perplexity citation	1 hour
11	**Replace hero animations with CSS**	Faster page load (LCP)	1 day

Do Within First Month

#	ACTION	IMPACT	EFFORT
12	**Launch blog** with 3-4 articles	Topical authority, long-tail traffic	1-2 weeks
13	**Create comparison pages** (vs Cluey, Mathletics, IXL)	Capture comparison shopping intent	2-3 days
14	**List on ProductReview.com.au**	Discovery in comparison SERPs	1 hour
15	**Display ABN + full contact details**	Australian business trust	30 minutes

Longer Term (3-6 Months)

#	ACTION	IMPACT	EFFORT

16	**Create YouTube explainer** (3-5 min)	Strongest AI citation signal	1-2 weeks
17	**Get editorial press mention**	Authority + backlinks	Ongoing
18	**Build year-level content**	Long-tail search traffic	Ongoing
19	**Teacher-facing landing page**	B2B2C channel opportunity	3-5 days

The Bottom Line

38/100 sounds alarming, but the path to 70+ is mostly technical plumbing.

The hard part — writing genuine, research-backed content that differentiates from competitors — is already done well. The research citations (Nature, PNAS, Harvard RCTs), transparent pricing, and clear methodology are a genuine competitive advantage that no other player in the Australian primary education space matches.

The top 4 fixes (making content visible to Google, fixing the sitemap, adding security headers, and adding structured data) are all engineering tasks that could be completed in **a focused week of work**. Doing just these four would likely lift the score to approximately **60-65/100**.

Once Google can actually see the content, the site has a genuine path to ranking.

Score Breakdown Explained

CATEGORY	SCORE	WHAT IT MEASURES
Technical SEO	**38**	Can search engines crawl and index the site correctly?
Content Quality	**49**	Is the content trustworthy, expert, and substantial?
On-Page SEO	**42**	Are titles, descriptions, headings, and tags optimised?
Structured Data	**0**	Does the site tell Google what type of content each page contains?
Performance	**55**	Does the site load fast and respond to interactions quickly?
AI Search Readiness	**41**	Can AI tools (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI) find and cite the content?
Images	**65**	Are images optimised? (Site uses SVGs — minimal issues)

Report generated from 8 parallel specialist analyses: Technical SEO, Content Quality (E-E-A-T), Schema Markup, Sitemap Structure, Core Web Vitals, Visual/Mobile, AI Search (GEO), and Search Experience (SXO).
Prepared for Upwise (Techne AI Pty Ltd) — 23 April 2026